during the East Pakistan/Bangladesh crisis) did not mean that India was no longer non-aligned. As Indira often stated, India was too large a country to be part of any bloc but it needed economic, military and scientific resources to be able to follow an independent policy.

For Indira, non-alignment meant India reserved 'the right to judge each international issue on its merits and keeping in view our national interests and interest of world peace'.[86] Like Nehru, non-alignment for Indira was 'an assertion of our freedom of judgement and action' as it demonstrated that India was not a camp follower.[87] Indira saw non-alignment as 'the only hard-headed, practical path that is open to any country which wants to keep itself independent'.[88]

While India under Indira still talked about the need for global peace and prosperity, what Indira sought was a 'new international economic order' [89] where the developing countries had a say and where only a few countries – like the permanent members of the UN Security Council – did not determine the balance of power.[90] While Nehru saw colonialism as the major threat facing the world, Indira saw neocolonialism as the new threat that India had to stand up against. In Indira's view, the Western world was trying to impose neocolonialism on the developing countries and India as their champion had to fight back.[91]

Indira wanted India to play the role of a leader in helping create this new economic order. In this she echoed the views of her fellow Indians, most of whom believed it natural that India would be a leader or guide to other developing countries. Indira's speeches critique the superpower blocs for seeking 'overseas possessions', for carving out 'spheres of influence' and erecting 'cordon sanitaires'.[92] In a 1972 *Foreign Affairs* article Indira spoke of the need to destroy 'past colonial feudal structures,' stay away from 'spheres of influence' and safeguard India's independence as well as maintain global peace. [93] That the legacy of anti-colonialism still framed India's foreign policy long after Independence can be seen in Indira's